Syria Narrative Tracker · Audience snapshot

What Syrian online audiences talk about, how they react, and how far they are from the media

11 September 2026 – 27 October 2026 · 46 days · 775 stories · 9,845 analyses of posts and comments by people and 4,917 by outlets

The Syria Narrative Tracker reads public posts and comments about Syria in Arabic, Kurdish and English several times a day (YouTube comments, Telegram channels, Bluesky, Reddit, X and news sites), groups them into stories and measures, story by story, the mood of ordinary people and the tone of each type of outlet. This snapshot draws audience indicators from that record. It describes what audiences say and do in public online; it does not represent all Syrians (see Method and limits).

Key findings

1. **Independent and private Syrian outlets are closest to the public mood.** On the stories they covered, people's mood went the same way as their tone (negative, neutral or positive) 77% of the time, against 53% for international news (via Google News). This is a proxy for whose framing audiences share, not a direct measure of trust.

2. **People are angrier than every type of outlet.** Across all outlet types, people's reactions were clearly more negative than the coverage on 53% to 69% of the stories; outlets' tone was on average mostly neutral, people's leaning negative.

3. **Doubt is widespread.** About 41% of people's attention went to stories where they voiced doubt about official accounts, promises or media reports, most of all on *transitional justice* (78%), *Israel and the south* (68%), *north-east and the Kurdish question* (55%).

4. **Coverage gaps.** People talk more than outlets cover about *society and daily life*, *north-east and the Kurdish question*, *governance and the new state*, while outlets give more room than people's attention to *international relations* and *economy and services*.

5. **Signs of fatigue.** *Governance and the new state* and *security and violence* lost a large part of people's attention in the second half of the period while outlets kept covering them. Tiredness, resignation or numbness marked 4% to 15% of people's attention from week to week.

6. **Video is where people react.** YouTube comments make up 45% of the conversation analysed; reactions to *governance and the new state* and *society and daily life* happen mostly under videos (75% and 73%).

7. **Arabic and English audiences differ.** Arabic reactions are leaning negative overall and centre on *Israel and the south*; English reactions are leaning negative and centre on *north-east and the Kurdish question*, and Kurdish reactions almost entirely on the north-east.

8. **Anger leads.** The emotions most present in reactions are anger (15%), distrust (7%), fear (7%), grief (7%); hope appears in 4% of them and pride in 5%.

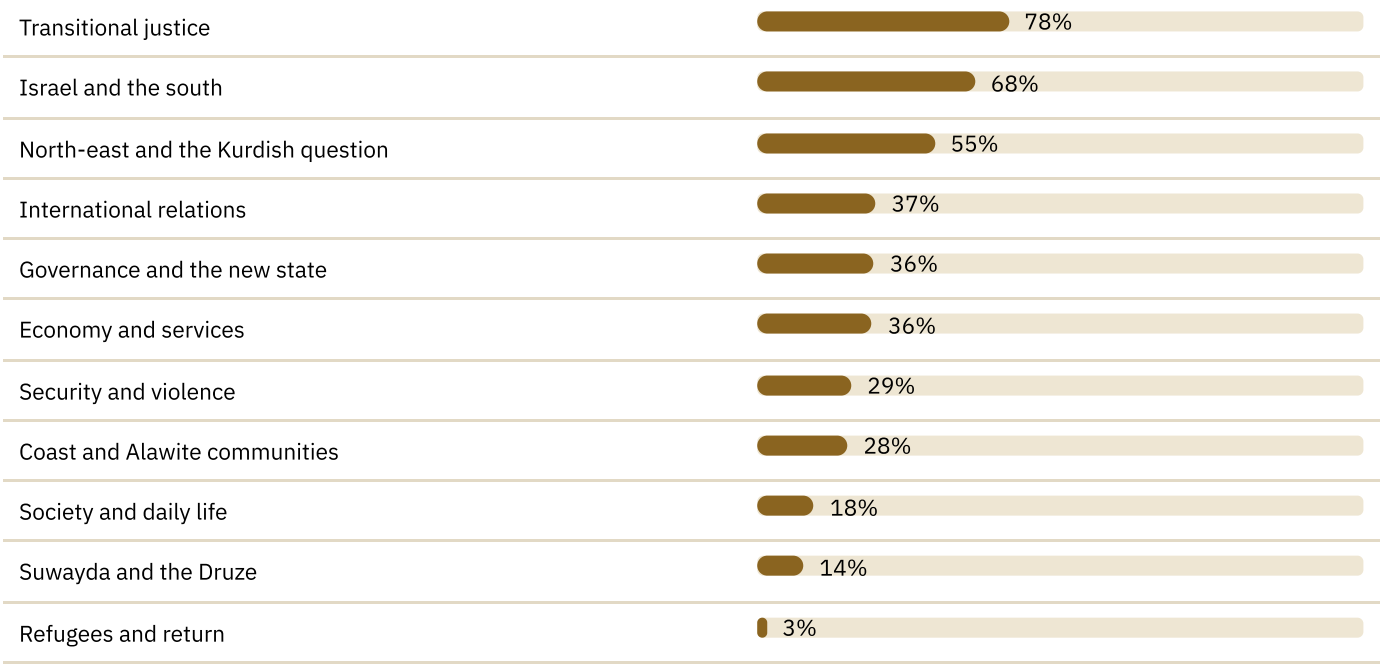
1. Outlets and the public mood

For each type of outlet, on the stories it covered: its tone, people's mood on the same stories, how often the two went the same way, and how often people were clearly more negative. Closeness suggests which outlets' framing audiences share; it is a proxy, and the survey's direct questions on trust are needed to explain why.

OUTLET TYPE	STORIES	OUTLETS' TONE	PEOPLE'S MOOD	SAME DIRECTION	PEOPLE MORE NEGATIVE
Independent and private Syrian outlets	180	Mostly neutral	Leaning negative	77%	60%
State media	103	Mostly neutral	Leaning negative	67%	53%
Kurdish outlets	133	Mostly neutral	Leaning negative	59%	64%
Arab and regional outlets	63	Mostly neutral	Leaning negative	57%	61%
International news (via Google News)	100	Mostly neutral	Leaning negative	53%	69%

2. Doubt about official accounts and media reports

Share of people's attention, by topic, on stories where people voiced doubt, suspicion or mockery about official accounts, promises or media reports (overall: 41%).



3. Gaps between coverage and attention

Each topic's share of people's posts and comments against its share of outlets' coverage over the period. Topics at the top get more attention from people than from outlets.

People Outlets

TOPIC	PEOPLE / OUTLETS	DIFFERENCE
Society and daily life	16% / 6%	+11 points
North-east and the Kurdish question	13% / 7%	+6 points
Governance and the new state	8% / 2%	+5 points
Suwayda and the Druze	6% / 3%	+3 points
Coast and Alawite communities	1% / 0%	same share
Refugees and return	2% / 2%	−1 point
Transitional justice	5% / 7%	−2 points
Israel and the south	18% / 23%	−4 points
Security and violence	7% / 11%	−4 points
Economy and services	13% / 20%	−6 points
International relations	12% / 19%	−8 points

4. Fatigue

How each topic's share of people's attention and of outlets' coverage changed between the first and the second half of the period (before and from 5 October 2026). A topic that loses people's attention while outlets keep covering it shows signs of fatigue.

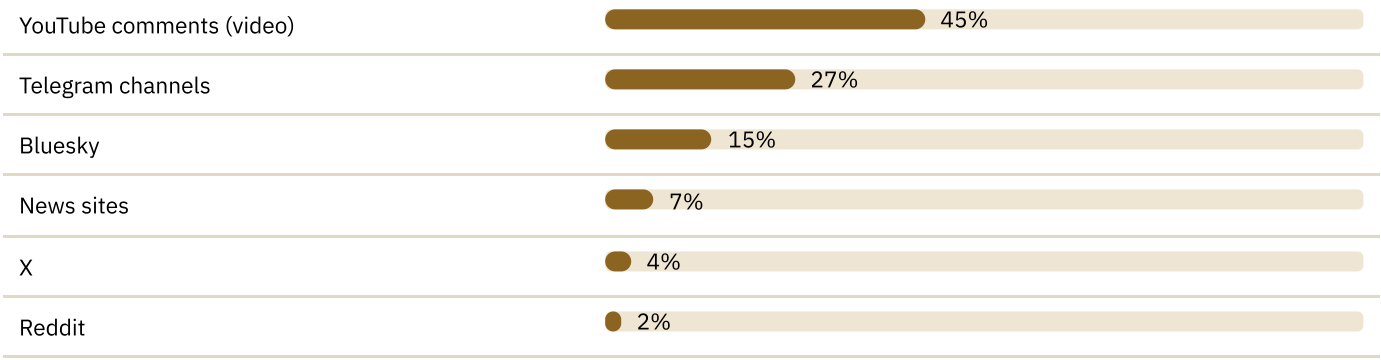
TOPIC	PEOPLE'S ATTENTION	OUTLETS' COVERAGE	
Society and daily life	28% → 9%	7% → 4%	
Governance and the new state	11% → 6%	2% → 2%	**signs of fatigue**
Security and violence	10% → 5%	10% → 12%	**signs of fatigue**
Economy and services	16% → 11%	25% → 16%	
International relations	12% → 11%	25% → 16%	
North-east and the Kurdish question	8% → 15%	6% → 7%	
Israel and the south	10% → 24%	11% → 30%	
Transitional justice	2% → 7%	7% → 6%	
Suwayda and the Druze	2% → 8%	1% → 4%	

Week by week, the share of people's attention on stories whose reactions carried tiredness, resignation or numbness, and on stories with voiced doubt:

WEEK	PEOPLE'S MOOD	TIREDNESS	DOUBT
2026-W38	Leaning negative	5%	14%
2026-W39	Mostly neutral	8%	34%
2026-W40	Leaning negative	15%	32%
2026-W41	Leaning negative	10%	32%
2026-W42	Mostly neutral	4%	52%
2026-W43	Leaning negative	13%	29%
2026-W44 (partial)	Strongly negative	5%	81%

5. Where people react, and what engages them

Share of the conversation analysed, by platform:



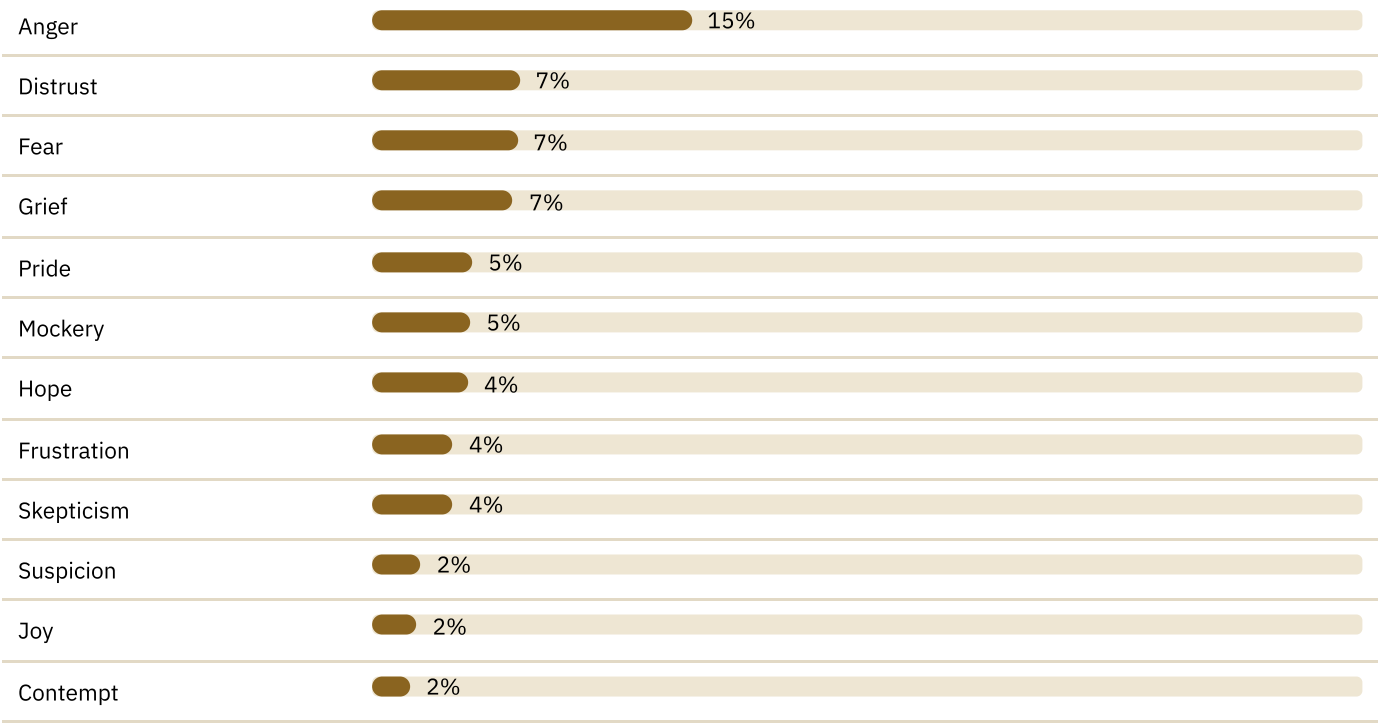
By topic: the share of reactions under videos (YouTube), and engagement per post (likes, views and comments the posts drew, as an index: the topic with the most is 100).

TOPIC	UNDER VIDEOS	ENGAGEMENT
Governance and the new state	75%	12
Society and daily life	73%	15
North-east and the Kurdish question	54%	10
Suwayda and the Druze	54%	15
Security and violence	39%	97
Refugees and return	39%	33
Israel and the south	37%	100
Economy and services	34%	46
Transitional justice	33%	46
International relations	30%	70

6. Languages

LANGUAGE	POSTS AND COMMENTS	MOOD	MAIN TOPICS (SHARE OF THE LANGUAGE'S REACTIONS, MOOD)
Arabic	4,609	Leaning negative	Israel and the south 19%, strongly negative; Economy and services 15%, leaning negative; Society and daily life 15%, mostly neutral
English	2,367	Leaning negative	North-east and the Kurdish question 37%, leaning negative; Israel and the south 24%, leaning negative; International relations 12%, mostly neutral
Kurdish	61	Mostly neutral	North-east and the Kurdish question 93%, mostly neutral; Transitional justice 3%, leaning positive; International relations 2%, mostly neutral

7. Emotions in reactions



Method and limits

Source. Public posts and comments about Syria collected several times a day from YouTube comments, Telegram channels, Bluesky, Reddit, X and news sites, in Arabic, Kurdish and English. An AI model (Claude, by Anthropic) groups them into stories and rates the tone of people and of each outlet type, story by story; a validation tool compares its coding with human coding. Each story counts once a day (the day's last analysis).

Outlet types. State media (SANA, the Presidency, Al-Ikhbariya); independent and private Syrian outlets (Enab Baladi, Syria TV, Al-Watan and others); Arab and regional outlets (Al Jazeera, Al Arabiya, Asharq, TRT Arabi, Anadolu and others); Kurdish outlets (ANHA, North Press, Rudaw, Kurdistan24); international news through Google News.

Indicators. Doubt: reactions the model described as sceptical, suspicious, mocking or disbelieving of official accounts, promises or reports. Fatigue: a topic's share of people's attention falling by a quarter or more while outlets' share holds; tiredness: reactions carrying tiredness, resignation, numbness, fatalism or helplessness. Engagement: likes, views and comments drawn by the posts analysed, per post.

Limits. People who post and comment in public are not a sample of all Syrians: the data says nothing about age, gender, education or income, about people who are offline or do

not post, or about private messaging (WhatsApp) and Facebook, which the tracker does not collect. Silence, news avoidance and self-censorship are invisible to it. Alignment with an outlet's tone is not trust. These indicators are meant to sit beside a representative survey, focus groups and interviews, which answer who audiences are, what they can access and why they trust what they trust.

Live site: www.syrianpulse.org · data as of 27 October 2026, 10:18 UTC. Individuals are never named, quoted or linked.